

March 11, 2026

Professor Klaus Desmet
Department of Economics
Southern Methodist University

Dear Professor Desmet,

I am writing to express my interest in the faculty recruitment effort in the Department of Economics at Southern Methodist University. I am currently a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University and expect to complete my degree in May 2026. While the current search focuses on senior hires, I wanted to introduce my work and express my strong interest in potential opportunities within the department.

My research focuses on macroeconomics and wealth inequality, with an emphasis on heterogeneous-agent models that incorporate differences in returns to wealth and income risk. In my job market paper, I develop a life-cycle model calibrated to microdata from the Survey of Consumer Finances in order to study the distributional dynamics of wealth accumulation. My work combines theoretical modeling with empirical calibration and computational methods using large-scale household datasets.

Beyond my current project, my broader research agenda examines how financial markets, macroeconomic policy, and household decision-making interact to shape economic inequality and aggregate outcomes. I am particularly interested in environments where rigorous quantitative research can inform debates on economic policy and financial markets.

SMU's Department of Economics is an exciting and growing research environment, and I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to its continued development in both research and teaching. I would be grateful for the chance to discuss whether my research program might align with future hiring plans for junior faculty.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards